

The Noble Prophecy of the Great Goddess Śrī

Ārya-Śrī-Yamahādevī-vyākaraṇa · Toh 193 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ལྷ་མོ་ཆོ་མོ་མ་དོལ་ལུ་བསྐྱེད་པ།

Toh 193 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Śrī-Yamahādevī-vyākaraṇa and in Tibetan as the Pakpa Lhamo Chenmo Pal Lungtenpa, rendered in English as The Noble Prophecy of the Great Goddess Śrī. It belongs to the class of vyākaraṇa, or prophecy texts, in which a buddha foretells the future spiritual attainments or destiny of a particular being — in this case the great goddess Śrī, a prominent divine figure in both Hindu and Buddhist traditions. The sūtra is set in the realm of Bliss, the pure land of Amitābha, where the Blessed One addresses a vast assembly of celebrated bodhisattvas including Avalokiteśvara, Vajrapāṇi, Kṣitigarbha, and Samantabhadra, among others. As a canonical Mahāyāna sūtra, it sits within the Kangyur, the Tibetan Buddhist collection of texts regarded as the word of the Buddha.

Here ends the Sūtra of the Great Vehicle.

In the language of India: Ārya-Śrī-Yamahādevī-vyākaraṇa. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Prophecy of the Great Goddess Śrī.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was in the realm of Bliss, together with a great assembly of bodhisattvas, namely: the great bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara; the great bodhisattva Mahāsthāmaprāpta, He Who Has Attained Great Power; the great bodhisattva Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, He Who Removes All Obscurations; the great bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha; the great bodhisattva Samantabhadra; the great bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha, Essence of Space; the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi; the great bodhisattva He Who Dispels All Fears; likewise the great bodhisattva He Who Holds All the Auspiciousness of Joy; the great bodhisattva He Who Holds All the Signs of Merit; the great bodhisattva He Who Holds the Sun, the Moon, and the Three Worlds; the great bodhisattva He Who Holds All the Auspiciousness of the Non-Buddhists; the great bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, Ever Youthful; and together with all the other great bodhisattvas of the Fortunate Aeon — all of them were present there.

Then the great bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara went to where the Blessed One was, bowed at the feet of the Blessed One, touching his head to the ground,

and sat to one side.

The Great Goddess Śrī also went before the Blessed One, bowed at his feet, touching her head to the ground, circumambulated him three times, bowed her head in homage to all the great bodhisattvas dwelling in the realm of Bliss, and sat to one side.

Then the Blessed One, adorned with many hundreds of thousands of merits and surrounded by as many Tathāgatas as there are ten millions, praised and extolled by Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā, and all the world-protectors, looked upon the Great Goddess Śrī and, in the voice of the Great Brahmā, spoke these words to the great bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara:

Avalokiteśvara, whoever among kings or ministers, monks or nuns, laymen or laywomen, brahmins, the warrior caste, the merchant caste, or the common people carries this hymn of praise called "The Hundred and Eight Unstained Renowned Names of the Great Goddess Śrī" — in the land of that king of the warrior caste, all terrors for those sentient beings, epidemic diseases, and every form of harm will be pacified. No dangers whatsoever from thieves, deceivers, or from humans or nonhumans will arise. Wealth, grain, storehouses, and all treasures will increase and flourish. And in the household of that king of the warrior caste, good fortune will assuredly come to dwell.

Then those great bodhisattvas spoke these words: Blessed One, these words you have so well declared — Excellent! Excellent! Whatever qualities and benefits accrue to those who hold the names of the Great Goddess Śrī, who hear them and take them into practice, those benefits will come to be for them all.

Then the great bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, spoke these words to the Blessed One: Blessed One, where did the Great Goddess Śrī plant her roots of virtue?

The Blessed One declared: The Great Goddess Śrī planted roots of virtue with as many Tathāgatas as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges. In a past era, in a world realm called Arisen from Jewels, there appeared in the world a Tathāgata named Jewel-Flower Ocean of Qualities, Splendor of Vaiḍūrya and Golden Mountain, Radiant with the Beauty of Golden Light. And with many other Tathāgatas beyond him, the Great Goddess Śrī likewise planted roots of virtue.

These names of Tathāgatas are themselves what cause the roots of virtue of the Great Goddess Śrī to increase and be fulfilled, and they perpetually follow in her wake. Here in this place they serve to: fully declare the Great Goddess Śrī's praises; dispel all evil; eliminate all faults and transgressions; render every body free from stain; gather and multiply wealth and grain; cut off poverty; summon and attract all gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (fragrance-eaters), asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras (half-humans), and great mahoragas (great serpents); pacify all epidemic disease, harm, conflict, disturbance, dispersal, and dispute; and bring the six perfections (pāramitās) to completion.

They are as follows. Homage to the Tathāgata Dense Splendor. Homage to the Tathāgata Jewel-Flower Ocean of Qualities, Splendor of Vaiḍūrya and Golden Mountain, Radiant with the Beauty of Golden Light. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of Auspiciousness at Every Shore of the Ganges's Fords. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of Sandalwood-Flower Brilliance and Starlight Radiance. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of All-Pervading Light Victorious in Battle. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Maṇḍala of the Ocean of Qualities Shining. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Victorious Banner of Dharma's Miraculous Display. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Peaceful Incense Light of Starlight. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Body that Pacifies the Intentions of Sentient Beings. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor Illuminated by an Ocean of Aspirations. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Name Most Perfectly Proclaimed. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Precious Abode of the Irreversible Wheel. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Supreme Radiance of the Solar Disk. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of One Who Has Entered into Innumerable Acts of Diligence. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Immeasurable Appearance of Golden Hue. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Melodious Tones of All the Branches of Speech. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Flower of Innumerable Rays of the Lamp of Wisdom. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of Mount Meru, the Armor of the Ascetic Practice of the Son of Non-Craving. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of Brahmā. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Great Lord. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Light of Sun and Moon. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the King of the Light of Profound Dharma.

Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Beautiful Light of the Lamp of Space. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Crest of Sunlight. Homage to the

Tathāgata Splendor of the Lamp of Incense. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor Arisen from the Essence of the Ocean. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Melodious Thunder of the Emanated Dragon. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Array of All Dharma Illuminations. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of One Born Like the King of Trees. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Mountain Radiating Jewel Light. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Ocean Radiating the Light of Wisdom. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Power of the Great Aspiration. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Great Cloud. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the King of the Crest of Mindfulness. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the King of Victory Banners, the Crest of the Sovereign. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Gatherer of All Wealth and Grain. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Guide to Peace. Homage to the Tathāgata Splendor of the Summoner of Excellence.

These names of the Tathāgatas should be taken up in proper sequence, held in mind, and recited. If one does so, the merit of that son or daughter of good family will increase greatly.

The Great Goddess Śrī was also prophesied by all the Tathāgatas. They declared: "Great Goddess Śrī, in a future time, in a world-realm called Adorned with the Precious Splendor, you will become a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha named Splendor Arisen from the Precious Jewel. That world-realm will be adorned with the many precious substances of the gods. That very Tathāgata will illuminate that world-realm, and the bodhisattvas dwelling in that world-realm will each radiate light from their own bodies and will have immeasurable lifespans. From the sky itself the sound of the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha will arise. All bodhisattvas who are to be born in that buddha-field will be born from the hearts of pure lotus flowers." Thus was the prophecy given.

Now, what is the praise in eighty-two verses known as the "Renowned as Immaculate, with One Hundred and Eight Names"? Listen to the names of the Great Goddess Śrī, the Sovereign of Fearlessness, Avalokiteśvara. They are as follows:

She who is consecrated by all the Tathāgatas. She who is consecrated by all the gods. She who is the mother of all the Tathāgatas. She who is the mother of all the gods. She who is the splendor of all the Tathāgatas. She who is the splendor of all bodhisattvas. She who is the splendor of all noble śrāvakas and

pratyekabuddhas. She who is the splendor of all Brahmās, Viṣṇus, and Great Lords (Śivas). She who is the splendor of all the gods and the rest. She who is the splendor present in all places. She who is the splendor of all gods (devas), nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (scent-eaters), asuras, garuḍas (sky-flyers), kinnaras (half-humans), and great mahoragas (great serpents). She who is the splendor of all vidyādhāras (mantra-holders), Vajrapāṇis, and all vajra-bearers. She who is the splendor of the four and five world-guardians. She who is the splendor of the eight planets and the twenty-eight lunar mansions.

Oṃ. Daughter of the Sun. Mama — the Mother. Splendor of the Four Vedas. The Auspicious One. Mother of sentient beings. The Victorious One. The Completely Victorious One. Gaṅgā. Auspicious One at all tīrthika doorways. The Immaculate. Splendor of the Immaculate Purifier. She who strips away all evil. The Without-Pride. Splendor of the Moon. Splendor of the Sun. Splendor of all moons.

She who rides a lion. She who is covered by a supreme hundred-thousand lotuses. She who abides on a lotus, on a lotus. She who holds a lotus. She who is born from a lotus. She who is endowed with a lotus. She who is encircled by many blazing rays of light. She who bestows wealth. The White One. The Great White One. She of the white hands. She who holds all auspiciousness. She who possesses a body formed of all accumulations of merit. Daughter of one endowed with wisdom. She who is endowed with a hundred-thousand hands. She who is endowed with a hundred-thousand eyes. She who is endowed with a hundred-thousand heads. She who bears a crown made beautiful with jewels of every variety. The Lovely-Formed. She of many forms. The Greatly Renowned. The Supremely Renowned. The Peaceful One. The Cloud. She of clean hair. She beautiful as the moon. She beautiful as the sun. The Virtuous One. She who creates virtue. Splendor of she who is manifest to all sentient beings. The Noble One. She who abides in flowers. The Lady of Flowers. Splendor of all mountains and the king of mountains, Mount Meru. Splendor of all rivers and lakes. Splendor of the ocean of all waters. Splendor of she who is manifest at all tīrthika doorways. Splendor of all medicines, herbs, trees, wealth, and grains. She who bestows gold. She who bestows food and clothing. The Luminous One. The Illuminating One. She of the pure body. She who governs all Tathāgatas. Splendor of she who is manifest to all the assemblies of gods. Splendor of Yama, Varuṇa, Kubera, Śakra (Indra), and the rest. She who gives. She who enjoys. She who possesses splendor. She who is perfectly endowed. The Prosperous One. She of abundant birth. The Beholding One.

Splendor of the Dharma. She who relies on Viṣṇu. She who abides on the kumuda lotus. She who is endowed with patience. Abode of might and power. She who possesses the hands of all purification and all auspiciousness. She who eliminates all inauspiciousness, splendor that gathers all merit. Splendor of all lands and all kings. Splendor of all kings of vidyādhāras. Splendor of all spirits, yakṣas, rākṣasas, hungry ghosts, flesh-eaters, kumbhāṇḍas, and great serpents. Splendor of the divine abodes and all gods. Splendor of all recitations and objects of recitation, all fire offerings and objects of fire offering, and all auspiciousness. She who delights in light. She who desires to be endowed with good fortune. Splendor that purifies all sages. Chief of all stations of womanhood, and supreme among all splendors — of all kiṃnaras, goddesses, and all female asuras. She who dwells in a place beyond all reproach. The Pleasing One. She who satisfies. She who is dear to the heart of Kubera. Splendor of the Dharma King.

Oṃ. Look upon all suffering. Liberate! Grant liberation! May all accumulations of merit become manifest in me. Svāhā.

Oṃ gaṃ ga sarva tīrtha mukhi svāhā. Oṃ sarva vitri svāhā. Oṃ sarva maṃgala dhāraṇai svāhā. Caturveda sarva nakṣatra graha vaṇa gaṇa adhimūrtai svāhā. Brahmāya svāhā. Viṣṇave svāhā. Rudrāya svāhā. Viśvamukhāya svāhā. Oṃ glīni klīni sarva kārya sādhanī. Sani sani. Āvaha devi śrī. Vaiśravaṇāya svāhā. Suvarṇa dhana dhanya. Ākarṣaṇyai svāhā. Sarva pūrṇa ākarṣaṇyai svāhā. Śrī hemavatyai ākarṣaṇyai svāhā. Sarva pāpa nāśanyai svāhā. Sarva akāla mṛtyu praśamanyai svāhā. Sarva tathāgata abhiṣekatāyai svāhā. Sarva devatā abhimukha śrīyai svāhā. Āyurbala vardhakārāyai svāhā. Sarva vidvān maṃgala hastāyai svāhā. Saṃhaṃ vāhinyai svāhā. Padmasaṃbhavāyai svāhā. Sarva kṛtya kakhorda vināśanyai svāhā.

The fearless one, Avalokiteśvara — the one in whom the great goddess Śrī, by the mere utterance of whose name all faults and misdeeds are eliminated, all sins are destroyed, all merit is gathered, all inauspiciousness is eliminated, and splendor and

happiness and all good fortune are gathered — whoever bears and recites these names of the Tathāgata: upon rising in the morning, having cleansed themselves, they should offer flowers and incense to all the buddhas, and offer sandalwood incense in particular to the great goddess Śrī. By reciting this, they will obtain all splendor, they will obtain every happiness and mental joy,

all the gods will guard, protect, and shelter them, and all their aims will be accomplished.

Having thus declared these words, the Blessed One — together with the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the fearless one, and the great goddess Śrī, and all of that assembly, and the gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas —

Translator's Notes

- The opening line "Here ends the Sūtra of the Great Vehicle" is a colophon marker that appears to belong to a preceding text, with the present sūtra title beginning immediately after. This is a standard scribal convention in Tibetan canonical collections where texts are copied sequentially.

The bodhisattva rendered "He Who Holds All the Auspiciousness of the Non-Buddhists" (mu stegs kyi bkra shis thams cad 'dzin pa) is a puzzling epithet. It likely refers to a bodhisattva who subsumes or encompasses all the blessings attributed to non-Buddhist traditions, asserting Buddhist supremacy over them; the exact identity of this figure is not established in standard enumerations.

- The epithet rendered "Tathāgata of the Shores of the Ganges's Fords" translates a name built around "gaṅgā-tīrtha," literally the fords or crossing-places of the Ganges, which in the Indian religious context denotes the sacred bathing and pilgrimage sites along the river; the full name suggests auspiciousness surpassing all such sacred sites of the non-Buddhists. The rendering "Son of Non-Craving" for "Sred med kyi bu" reflects the standard Tibetan epithet for the bodhisattva who later becomes the buddha of that name, and is retained as a proper name rather than a descriptive phrase.

- The epithet "Sovereign of Fearlessness, Avalokiteśvara" applied to the Great Goddess Śrī is doctrinally significant: this text identifies Śrī-devī as a manifestation or aspect of Avalokiteśvara, a standard Tibetan Buddhist identification. The rendering follows the Tibetan syntax directly.

The term "garuḍas" renders རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྔ་པ་ (literally "sky-soaring"), the standard Tibetan equivalent of Skt. garuḍa; "kinnaras" renders རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྔ་པ་ (literally "is it a human?"), and "mahoragas" renders རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྔ་པ་ (literally "great belly-crawlers").

"Mama" in the dhāraṇī invocation is left as the Tibetan phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit seed-syllable or invocative term within the mantra sequence and is not translated, as it functions as a mantra element.

- The passage is a litany of epithets followed by mantric dhāraṇī syllables, then a closing eulogy. The Sanskrit mantra strings have been rendered in reconstructed normalized Sanskrit; the Tibetan phonetic transcription is at times irregular, and the normalization follows standard identification of the deities and terms involved. The term རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྔ་པ་ (kumbhāṇḍa) denotes a class of spirits with gourd-shaped bodies. The closing sentence breaks off mid-clause at རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྔ་པ་ — the passage ends incompletely here, continuing in the next segment.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.